

11.4 I Dropped My Phone in Water

Take a random poll of your friends. Chances are, at least one of them has dropped his or her phone into some kind of liquid. Hopefully, the liquid was clean water, but we both know people who have dropped their phone in rather unmentionable places.

So what do you do if your phone comes in contact with water? (If you dropped your phone into some other liquid, like a glass of coke, it's almost surely dead.) Well, there are no guarantees that these steps will work, but if you follow them, they will give you the best chance of being able to use your phone again:

- Immediately remove your phone's back cover and battery.
- Set the phone, battery, and cover on a dry, lint-free towel.
- Do not touch the phone for three days.
- Has it been three days? No? Don't touch the phone. Really.
- Put the battery back in the phone, replace the cover, and try to power on the phone.
- If the phone doesn't turn on, or behaves oddly, you can remove the battery again and leave the phone for another two days.

If, after the full five days, the phone still doesn't work, it probably never will. Electronics don't respond well to water, and they do even worse if submerged in most any other liquid. However, unless your phone shorts out when it is dropped in the water, it is very possible that after the phone and all of its internal components dry completely, the phone will work just fine. We recommend three to five days of drying time.

11.5 Resetting Your Phone

Not to sound like a broken record, but if your phone crashes, or locks up (stops responding to anything you do), or just runs slower than you can stand, and the previous procedures don't fix the problems, you probably need to reset it. This should be used only as a last resort, because you will lose all installed applications and all custom data stored on the phone. Any information that you have stored in your Google account, such as your contacts and email, will still exist in your Google account, but you'll have to set up the phone again to synchronize that information to your phone.

To reset your phone, follow these steps:

- Power off the phone by pressing the red Hang Up button.
- After the device has powered down, hold down the Home key and press the red Hang Up button to restart the phone. Keep the keys held down until